ACE SHOT

FIRST INDIAN FEMALE SHOOTER TO WIN AN OLYMPIC MEDAL

Male medalists include Abhinav Bindra, Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore, Gagan Narang, Vijay Kumar, Swapnil Kusale and Sarabjot Singh

ONLY INDIAN ATHLETE, MALE OR FEMALE, TO WIN TWO MEDALS IN AN OLYMPICS

Last one was in pre-Independence India and won by a British Indian athlete

AN IMPRESSIVE SHOWING IN PARIS

In fine form, she qualified for the finals of all the three events in which she competed

ONE OF ONLY FOUR SHOOTERS

from the disappointing Tokyo squad to retain their spots in Paris



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want her to have that happiness in Tokyo]." Redemption came to Rana too. From being persona non grata and the fall guy in Tokyo, he is now being celebrated as the chief architect of Manu's success in Paris. "With her help," says Rana, "I am no longer carrying on my head the blame that had been haunting me for two years. It is the biggest relief I have felt in my life."

RISING FROM THE ASHES

Every athlete knows failure is a better teacher than success. Tokyo proved to be a harsh lesson for Manu. She had been unable to sleep after her pistol developed a snag in the qualifications for the 10m air pistol event, costing her time, focus and, finally, a shot at the finals. The next night had been no better, despite trying everything from music to yoga and meditation. Unsuccessful in her desperate quest for sleep, she had called her physiotherapist complaining of a headache and seeking medication. "I was so tired, my brain wouldn't



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